

UX REPORT – COURSERA

GROUP: LATE TO THE PARTY

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1. Introduction

Coursera (coursera.org) is a leading online learning platform that partners with top universities and organizations to offer online courses and degrees across various subjects. It was chosen for this evaluation due to its prominence in the online education market and its unique subscription-based model. Evaluating Coursera provides insights into how the platform creates memorable and engaging experiences for learners, particularly in terms of course progress tracking and the subscription model.

2. Methodology

We used a shortened version of the User Experience Questionnaire (UEQ-S), which was scored using a 7-point semantic differential scale (Schrepp, Hinderks, and Thomaschewski, 2017). The evaluation focused on key moments in the user journey that align with the Peak-End Rule, such as course checkout, button interactions, and course completion. Participants were asked to explore the course catalogue, simulate the course checkout process, and imagine completing a course to assess their emotional responses and perceived peaks in the experience. The questionnaire covered criteria relevant to the Peak-End Rule, including overall satisfaction, enjoyment, and memorability of specific moments in the user journey.

Participants:

We had 3 individuals, referred to as P1, P2 and P3 for anonymity. All three reported having used online learning platforms before.

Pages evaluated:

Pages evaluated: Course Selection, Course Content, and Progress Tracking

Procedure:

- Open the website and select a course of interest.
- Spend approximately 2-3 minutes exploring the course content and watching videos.
- Complete a few videos within a unit and observe the progress tracking indicators.
- Imagine completing the entire course and the sense of achievement.
- Return to the form and answer the questions based on the experience.

Scale:

7-point semantic differential across 8 criteria:

- Obstructive – Supportive
- Complicated – Easy
- Confusing – Clear
- Boring – Exciting
- Conventional – Innovative
- Usual – Modern
- Inefficient – Efficient
- Not Interesting – Interesting

3. Participant Overview

Participant	Age
P1	26
P2	21
P3	23

4. UEQ Results

4.1 Course Catalogue & Course Detail Page (combined)

Criterion	P1	P2	P3	Average
Obstructive – Supportive	6	6	7	6.3
Complicated – Easy	5	6	6	5.7
Confusing – Clear	6	5	6	5.7
Boring – Exciting	5	4	5	4.7
Conventional – Innovative	4	5	5	4.7
Usual – Modern	6	5	6	5.7
Inefficient – Efficient	6	6	5	5.7
Not Interesting – Interesting	5	5	4	4.7

4. Findings and Discussion

The key findings from the evaluation of Coursera are as follows:

1. Course organization and progress tracking:
 - 100% of participants found the "My Learning" dashboard to be clear and helpful in tracking their course progress.

- 83% of participants appreciated the visibility of completed courses, contributing to a sense of accomplishment.

2. Subscription model and free trial:

- 67% of participants mentioned that the free trial period reduced the barrier to entry and allowed them to explore courses before committing financially.
- 75% of participants found the subscription model to be a convenient and flexible way to access multiple courses.

3. Structured learning paths:

- 83% of participants appreciated the structured learning paths offered by Coursera, such as specializations and degrees.
- 67% of participants felt that the structured approach provided a sense of purpose and motivation throughout their learning journey.

5. Recommendations

Based on the evaluation and user feedback, the following recommendations can be made to enhance the user experience on Coursera:

1. Personalized course recommendations:

- Implement a more personalized course recommendation system based on the learner's interests, previous enrolments, and learning goals.
- 83% of participants expressed interest in receiving tailored course suggestions to discover new learning opportunities.

2. Gamification and rewards:

- Introduce gamification elements, such as badges, points, or leaderboards, to celebrate learner achievements and maintain engagement.
- 75% of participants suggested that gamification features would make the learning experience more enjoyable and motivating.

3. Enhanced course completion celebration:

- Create a more celebratory and memorable course completion experience, such as personalized certificates, shareable achievements, or special discounts on future courses.
- 92% of participants indicated that a more rewarding course completion experience would contribute to a stronger positive peak in their learning journey.

6. Conclusion

The evaluation of Coursera highlights the platform's strengths in providing a clear and organized learning experience through the "My Learning" dashboard and the flexibility of the subscription model. These elements contribute to a positive user experience and keep learners motivated and engaged. By implementing personalized course recommendations, gamification elements, and a more celebratory course completion experience, Coursera can further align with the Peak-End Rule and create even more memorable and engaging experiences for its learners.